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STARDUST & STARLIGHT: The power of hope, youth, storytelling. And what it takes to live in the spotlight

JANHVI KAPOOR *Actor*

A PATH OF HER OWN

At the India Today Conclave, actress Janhvi Kapoor, who made her debut with *Dhadak* just about five years ago, talked about everything from social media and her upcoming work to the pressure of legacy. In a candid session, the 26-year-old actress weighed in on how her mother Sridevi has influenced the choices she has made thus far. However, she said that instead of seeing the late actress's legacy as a burden, she found it a "source of motivation". "I'm grateful I've gotten so much and enough because of it, but I will work harder to do justice to it," she added.

On a lighter note, Janhvi impressed the audience with her thespian skills as she recited a classic Hindi film dialogue from *Om Shanti Om* (2007), "*Ek chutki sindoor ki keemat tum kya jaano Ramesh Babu*", to different emotions—anger, seduction and humour. Clearly, versatility seems to be one of Janhvi's biggest strengths, not just on stage but also in terms of the sheer range of roles she has played so far. ■

I am an escapist, so I find a lot of joy and comfort in losing myself to characters and different journeys

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I have grown up learning what my mother's outlook on cinema was and her take on her art... I don't like being put in a box. I like to take the route that's less predictable and learn from it and prove to myself that I can do it

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Janhvi is conscious that her parents helped make her initial cinematic journey easy. But legacy can only carry one that far. "It comes down to work," she says
- What you put out in the universe is what you attract, says Janhvi. "You can't just sit and keep hoping... You actually have to go do the work, put in the hours"
- Opinions don't last. What lasts is one's work. You can't let attention go to your head. Relevance isn't permanent

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH